Communication Skills

Materials & Notes

Module 1: Introduction to Communication

1.1 What is Communication?

Communication is the process of sharing information, ideas, thoughts, and feelings between people. Effective communication helps people understand one another clearly in personal, academic, and professional situations. Communication can take place through speaking, writing, gestures, facial expressions, and other forms of non-verbal expression.

1.2 Elements of Communication

• Sender – the person who starts the communication.
• Message – the information being communicated.
• Channel – the method used to communicate the message.
• Receiver – the person who receives the message.
• Feedback – the response given by the receiver.

1.3 Types of Communication

The major types include verbal communication, non-verbal communication, written communication, and visual communication.

Module 2: Verbal Communication

2.1 Speaking Clearly

Effective speaking involves using clear words, suitable vocabulary, correct pronunciation, and an appropriate tone. Speakers should organize their ideas before speaking and avoid unnecessary repetition.

2.2 Tone and Voice

Tone communicates attitude and emotion. A professional speaker should use a polite, confident, and suitable tone depending on the situation. Voice speed and volume should also be controlled so that listeners can follow the message comfortably.

2.3 Conversation Skills

Good conversation involves taking turns, asking relevant questions, responding appropriately, and showing interest in what others say.

Module 3: Listening Skills

3.1 Active Listening

Active listening means paying full attention to the speaker, understanding the message, and responding appropriately. It is more than simply hearing words.

3.2 Techniques for Better Listening

• Maintain appropriate attention.
• Avoid interrupting unnecessarily.
• Ask questions when clarification is needed.
• Summarize important points.
• Give suitable feedback.

3.3 Barriers to Listening

Noise, distractions, lack of concentration, assumptions, emotional reactions, and interrupting can reduce listening effectiveness.

Module 4: Non-Verbal Communication

4.1 Body Language

Non-verbal communication includes facial expressions, gestures, posture, eye contact, and body movements. These signals can support or sometimes contradict spoken words.

4.2 Professional Body Language

In professional situations, maintain appropriate eye contact, use an attentive posture, and avoid distracting movements. Positive body language can help communicate confidence and respect.

Module 5: Written Communication

5.1 Effective Writing

Good written communication should be clear, concise, organized, and appropriate for the intended reader. Use simple language, meaningful headings, and a logical structure.

5.2 Email Communication

A professional email should have a clear subject, polite greeting, concise message, appropriate closing, and necessary attachments. The message should be checked for spelling and grammar before sending.

5.3 Formal and Informal Communication

Formal communication is generally used in academic and professional settings, while informal communication is more suitable for casual conversations with friends and familiar people.

Module 6: Presentation and Public Speaking

6.1 Preparing a Presentation

A good presentation begins with a clear objective and organized content. A simple structure is introduction, main points, examples or evidence, and conclusion.

6.2 Public Speaking

Public speaking involves presenting ideas to an audience. Preparation, practice, clear speech, suitable pace, and confident delivery can improve presentation effectiveness.

6.3 Handling Questions

Listen carefully to each question, take a moment to understand it, and answer clearly. If you do not know an answer, respond honestly rather than giving incorrect information.

Module 7: Group Discussion and Interview Skills

7.1 Group Discussion

A successful group discussion requires active listening, relevant contributions, respectful disagreement, and cooperation. Participants should support their opinions with clear reasons and allow others to speak.

7.2 Interview Communication

Interview communication includes introducing yourself confidently, answering questions clearly, describing your skills honestly, and asking relevant questions when appropriate.

7.3 Professional Communication

Professional communication should be respectful, clear, responsible, and suitable for the workplace. It includes conversations, meetings, emails, presentations, and teamwork.

Module 8: Confidence and Communication Improvement

8.1 Building Confidence

Communication confidence develops through preparation, regular practice, constructive feedback, and experience. Practicing short speeches, conversations, presentations, and interviews can gradually improve confidence.

8.2 Common Communication Barriers

Language difficulties, fear of making mistakes, lack of preparation, poor listening, unclear messages, and distractions can affect communication. Identifying these barriers is the first step toward improving communication.

Learning Outcomes

- Communicate ideas clearly and confidently.
- Improve active listening skills.
- Use appropriate verbal and non-verbal communication.
- Write effective professional messages and emails.
- Participate effectively in group discussions.
- Develop presentation and interview communication skills.